



RECOMMENDED PACKING LIST

Summer and Autumn on Hurricane Island can be warm and sunny during the day, cooler in the evening. April, May, and June can remain chilly on the island. Weather conditions are unpredictable and frequent changes in the weather patterns are common. Most of what we do on Hurricane takes place rain or shine, so we recommend being prepared for anything! And island life can be rustic, dusty, and hard-working so we suggest bringing gear and clothing that you do not mind getting dirty, stained, or worn out.

FOOTWEAR:

For your safety and to act as a role-model for students, we ask that you wear footwear at all times.

- **Close-Toed Shoes:** If you are working with the Facilities or Galley crew, you must wear close-toed shoes for safety reasons.
- **Rain Boots or Waterproof Shoes:** Due to the granite base of Hurricane Island, when it rains, there is nowhere for the water to go, and puddles stick around for days. We recommend a pair of waterproof shoes or boots with non-skid soles.
- **Running / Hiking Shoes:** If you are a hiker or runner, our trails are excellent, but the terrain is rocky and uneven so bring shoes appropriate for your favorite activity.
- **Sandals:** You are welcome to wear sandals if you prefer. We recommend sandals that can get wet and have heel straps – Teva-type water sandals. We do not recommend flip-flops for general island wear but may be nice to have as shower shoes.

CLOTHING:

Whatever the season, we have found that layers are essential.

- **T-Shirts:** Cotton shirts are ok, but we recommend at least one shirt of synthetic material or wool that will keep you warm even if wet.
- **Long-Sleeve Shirts:** Good for chilly days, they also help protect you from the sun. These can be cotton, flannel or synthetic.
- **Wind Layer:** This can be the same as your rain jacket or a separate layer that isn't waterproof but will protect you from the wind.
- **Sweater/Fleece:** We recommend at least one warm layer of fleece or wool for cooler days and evenings. In the spring or fall, we recommend extra layers including a vest or secondary jacket.
- **Base Layer:** During the shoulder seasons, we recommend bringing synthetic or wool base layer.
- **Pants + Shorts:** These can be cotton or synthetic material. Please bring at least one pair of durable pants that you don't mind getting a little dirty.
- **Swimwear:** If you can tolerate Maine's "bracing" ocean water, you are welcome to swim on Hurricane Island.

OUTERWEAR:

Weather on Hurricane can often be 10-15 degrees cooler than on the mainland or even have our own weather system, including being engulfed in fog for multiple days.

- **Rain Jacket:** We recommend a Gore-Tex or coated-nylon waterproof jacket, with seams that are taped or welded so they can't leak.
- **Rain Pants:** Waterproof pants are nice for foggy or rainy weather.

HEAD, HANDS and FEET:

- **Hats:** It can get chilly even in the middle of summer, so we recommend a warm hat.
- **Mittens / Gloves:** We have work gloves on the island, but in the shoulder-season, it helps to have either warm mittens or gloves.
- **Socks:** Depending on the weather, synthetic/wool socks might be preferable, but cotton may be fine. We recommend at least one pair of thick, warm, water-repellant socks.

BEDDING:

Our cabins and wall tents are furnished with single bed frames and mattresses – the rest is up to you! We recommend the following:

- **Sleeping Bag:** Synthetic or down material – not cotton – with a rating to at least 30°F.
- **Pillow:** With pillowcase.
- **Sheet:** If you use a sleeping bag, this may not be necessary but recommended. Fitted sheets should be sized for a twin mattress.
- **Blanket/Throw** (optional): While the sleeping bag should keep you warm and cozy, you may want just a simple blanket – or both on chilly nights!

TOILETRIES + MEDICATIONS:

Since the shower house facilities are shared, storage is limited and openly accessible by all. We suggest transporting toiletries to and from your cabin/tent as needed.

- **Oral Hygiene:** toothbrush, toothpaste, and other oral care products.
- **Glasses/contacts:** Consider bringing a second pair of glasses or extra contacts, just in case.
- **Prescription Medications:** We have over-the-counter pain relievers on hand but ask you to remember your prescriptions.
- **Insect Repellent:** In certain seasons, Hurricane Island does have bugs... Bring what you like best.

OTHER ITEMS:

The following is a list of other items you may want to bring.

- **Headlamp / Flashlight:** Cabins and tents do not have lights, and there is no outdoor lighting between buildings. We recommend headlamps for hands-free navigation after dark.
- **Small Backpack:** This might be helpful if you choose to hike around the island.
- **Water Bottle:** Although we have spares, you may want to bring your own water bottle.
- **Towel:** Synthetic pack towels dry more quickly, but cotton towels are fine.
- **Watch** (optional): In order to create a rustic, engaging learning environment, we prohibit student use of devices during programs. We ask that you do not use your phone around students, even to check the time.